

AI-Assisted Software Development

Module 8d: Refinement and Quality with AI Tools

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Overview

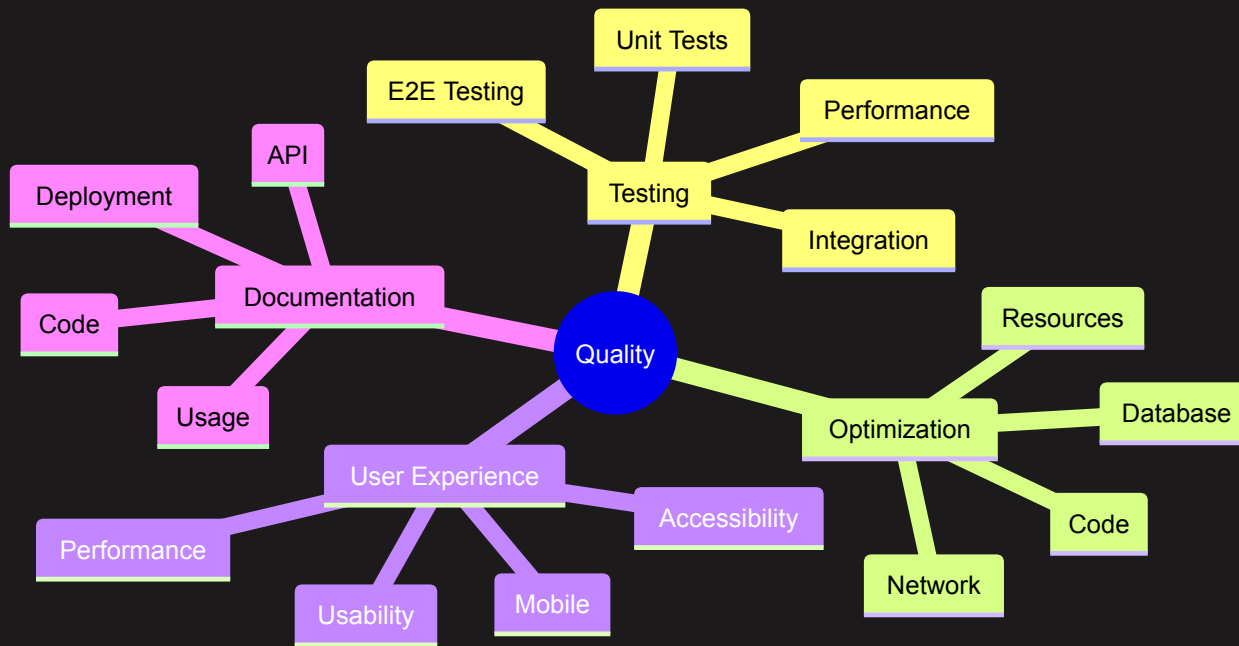
What we'll cover:

- Practical testing approaches
- Real-world optimization
- Code quality improvements
- UX refinement
- Production readiness

Using AI tools for:

- Test generation
- Performance analysis
- Code review
- UX validation
- Security checks

The Quality Process



AI-Assisted Test Generation

Example prompt for test case generation:

```
Generate unit tests for the authentication module.  
(Include context if needed.)
```

You can also add specifications and constraints. Examples:

- Ensure the output is in JSON format, similar to this example: ...
- Create tests for edge cases, such as empty input, invalid email format, etc.
- Create end-to-end tests for the critical path, such as a user logging in and out.
- Create data-driven tests for this function: ...

Testing Strategy

Ask AI to review your testing approach:

```
"Review this testing strategy for gaps:  
- Unit tests for utilities  
- Integration tests for API  
- E2E tests for critical paths  
- Performance tests for API endpoints"
```

Performance Analysis Prompts

Real-world examples:

1. Query Optimisation

Analyze this query for performance issues:

```
SELECT u.*, p.*, c.*  
FROM users u  
LEFT JOIN posts p ON u.id = p.user_id  
LEFT JOIN comments c ON p.id = c.post_id  
WHERE u.status = 'active'  
ORDER BY p.created_at DESC;
```

2. Frontend Performance

- Review this React component for performance: ...

Code Quality Prompts

Example prompts
for code review:

1. Pattern Review

```
Review this code for potential patterns  
and suggest improvements: ...
```

2. Code Review

```
Use AI for code review:
```

```
"Review this PR for:  
- Performance issues  
- Security concerns  
- Best practices  
- Potential bugs  
- Edge cases  
- Error handling"
```

3. Error Handling

```
Improve error handling in this code:
```

```
async function processOrder(orderId) {  
  const order = await getOrder(orderId);  
  const payment = await processPayment(order);  
  await updateInventory(order);  
  await sendConfirmation(order);  
  return order;  
}
```

UX Refinement Examples

Real-world UX improvement prompts:

1. Form Validation

Suggest improvements for this form:

```
<form onSubmit={handleSubmit}>  
  // ...  
  <button type="submit">Submit</button>  
</form>
```

2. Error Messages

Review these error messages for user-friendliness:

- "Error 404: Resource not found"
- "Database connection failed"
- "Invalid input in field 'email'"

Security Review Prompts

Example security analysis:

1. Authentication Flow

Review this authentication flow for security issues:

1. User submits email/password
2. Backend validates credentials
3. Generate JWT token
4. Store token in localStorage
5. Include token in Authorization header

2. Data Validation

Check this input validation for security:

```
function processUserInput(data) {  
  // ...  
}
```

Performance Optimisation Examples

Real-world optimization prompts:

1. React Component

Optimize this component for performance:

```
function ProductList({ products }) {  
  // ...  
}
```

2. API Endpoint

Optimize this API endpoint for performance:

```
app.get('/api/users', async (req, res) => {  
  // ...  
});
```

Error Handling Improvements

Example error handling prompts:

1. API Error Handling

Improve error handling in this API:

```
app.post('/api/orders', async (req, res) => {  
  try {  
    // ...  
  } catch (error) {  
    res.status(500).json({ error: error.message });  
  }  
});
```

2. Frontend Error Boundaries

Review this error boundary implementation:

```
class ErrorBoundary extends React.Component {  
  // ...  
}
```

Documentation Examples

Real-world documentation prompts:

1. API Documentation

```
Generate comprehensive documentation  
for this endpoint:
```

```
POST /api/users  
Body: {  
  name: string  
  email: string  
  role?: 'user' | 'admin'  
  preferences?: {  
    theme: 'light' | 'dark'  
    notifications: boolean  
  }  
}
```

2. Component Documentation

```
Document this React component:
```

```
function DataTable({  
  data,  
  columns,  
  sortable = true,  
  filterable = false,  
  pagination = true,  
  onClick,  
  onSort,  
  onFilter  
) {  
  // Component implementation  
}
```

Common Pitfalls and Solutions

1. Performance Issues

Ask AI to identify problems:

"Review this code for performance issues:

- Unnecessary re-renders
- N+1 queries
- Memory leaks
- Unoptimized assets"

2. Security Concerns

Use AI for security review:

"Check this implementation for:

- SQL injection risks
- XSS vulnerabilities
- CSRF protection
- Authentication bypass"

Recap

- Use specific, detailed prompts
- Include context and requirements
- Ask for multiple approaches
- Validate AI suggestions
- Iterate on improvements
- Document decisions
- Test thoroughly

Next Steps

- Apply these prompts to your code
- Create your prompt library
- Build testing templates
- Establish review checklist
- Set up monitoring